

3.7 Portable Fun

Perhaps the best thing about digital video is the fact that we can store it on portable devices for viewing on the road. Today, the amount of portable devices and gadgets available that can store and playback audio and video is on the rise.

Earlier, we would have to rely on laptops to carry entertainment with us. Though portable audio gadgets have been getting smaller and smaller, video face the problem of requiring a screen for viewing. This puts a limit on the amount that manufacturers can shrink a device, and thus affects portability.

Thankfully, major manufacturers have found a way to offer us just the right mix of portability and viewing comfort, in gadgets such as the iRiver and PDAs.

Yes, even PDAs are capable of storing a full movie or two: the Palm Zire 72 for instance, can store a full 700 MB movie on a 512 MB card, thanks to its Palm Desktop software, which compresses a video by reducing its size to fit the Zire 72's screen. This obviously makes the file about four times smaller, and makes

